

AI Tool Approval Mini-Checklist

Tool name:

Vendor:

Requesting team:

Business owner:

Date:

How to use. Use this mini-checklist for quick first-pass review of low-risk AI tools or features. If any stop trigger applies, use the full AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment or route the request to legal, privacy, security, procurement, or leadership review.

1. Request snapshot

1.1 What does the tool do?

1.2 What problem does it solve?

1.3 Who will use it?

1.4 How often will it be used?

1.5 Is there already an approved tool that does this?

- ☐ No
- ☐ Yes - explain why another tool is needed:

2. Stop triggers

If any answer below is yes, pause. Use the AI Risk Tiering Decision Tree and route the request to the AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment or a qualified reviewer.

Question	Yes / No	Notes
Will the tool process customer, employee, student, patient, financial, health, biometric, legal, or regulated data?		
Will it materially influence decisions about people?		
Will output be shown directly to customers, applicants, patients, students, or the public?		
Will it connect to email, CRM, files, code repositories, databases, production		

systems, or other internal systems?		
Will it act autonomously, send messages, make purchases, change records, or trigger workflows?		
Will it be used in hiring, lending, housing, insurance, healthcare, education, legal, government, or safety contexts?		
Does the vendor use customer inputs to train models by default?		
Is the vendor missing basic privacy, terms, or security information?		

If any stop trigger is yes: do not approve through this mini-checklist. Use the AI Risk Tiering Decision Tree and the AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment.

3. Basic fit check

Item	Check	Notes
Business purpose is clear	☐	
Expected users are identified	☐	
Data inputs are public, non-sensitive, or approved for this tool	☐	
Vendor privacy policy reviewed	☐	
Vendor terms reviewed for business use	☐	
Training/use-for-improvement setting reviewed	☐	
Opt-out confirmed where available	☐	
Basic security posture reviewed	☐	
Cost and renewal terms understood	☐	
Exit path understood	☐	

4. Approval scope

If approved, document the exact scope. Approval for one use is not approval for every use.

Approved users / teams:

Approved use cases:

Approved data categories:

Not approved for:

Required human review:

Conditions:

5. Decision

- ☐ Approved for limited low-risk use
- ☐ Approved with conditions
- ☐ Needs full AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment
- ☐ Needs legal/privacy/security/procurement review
- ☐ Rejected

Decision owner:

Decision date:

Next review date:

6. After approval

- ☐ Add tool to AI Use Inventory
- ☐ Add owner and review date
- ☐ Add approved scope and conditions
- ☐ Add training/use-for-improvement status
- ☐ Notify approved users
- ☐ Add to approved tools list if applicable
- ☐ Log future material changes in the AI Update Tracker

Disclaimer

This document is a template for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Consult qualified counsel before relying on this checklist for procurement, privacy, security, or compliance decisions.